

Annex Q

IRGC Access Compliance Protocol

May be Incorporated by Reference into Any Existing or Future Framework

Version 1.0 — June 2026

Closes Gap 3: IRGC Control of Access to Nuclear Sites

Authorized Negotiators Only — Confidential — Not for Public Distribution

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Preamble

Purpose

To address the operational reality that the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) exercises control over access to certain declared Iranian nuclear facilities, independent of the Atomic Energy Organization of Iran (AEOI). This Annex establishes that the national government of Iran bears sole responsibility for ensuring IRGC compliance with IAEA access rights under Annex O. It creates a single chain of accountability, designates a National Access Coordinator with authority to compel IRGC cooperation, and provides expedited consequences for IRGC-led access denials.

Background

The IRGC's role in Iran's nuclear infrastructure is well-documented. At multiple declared facilities, IRGC personnel control perimeter security, internal checkpoints, tunnel access, and building entry. This creates a structural gap between Iran's diplomatic commitments to IAEA access and the operational reality on the ground. The IAEA has encountered situations where IRGC personnel have denied or delayed inspector access independently of AEOI authorization. This Annex closes that gap by establishing that IRGC actions are attributable to the Iranian state, creating binding mechanisms to compel IRGC cooperation, and providing accelerated consequences when the IRGC interferes with verification.

Core Principles

This Annex operates on three foundational principles:

Principle 1: Attributability. The IRGC is an arm of the Iranian state. Actions by IRGC personnel at nuclear facilities are attributable to Iran. No legal or factual distinction shall be made between access denied by the IRGC and access denied by any other Iranian authority.

Principle 2: Accountability. The national government of Iran bears the sole and non-delegable responsibility for ensuring IAEA access, including at IRGC-controlled facilities. How Iran achieves compliance internally is a matter of Iranian domestic law, not a basis for excusing non-performance.

Principle 3: Expedited Consequences. IRGC-led access denials trigger accelerated breach consequences because IRGC control is a known structural risk, not an unforeseeable event. The standard pre-arbitration consultation period does not apply to IRGC-led denials.

Modularity Clause

This Annex is self-contained and may be incorporated into any existing or future agreement between the Parties by a single sentence of adoption. It does not amend or supersede conflicting provisions of any parent framework unless the Parties explicitly so agree. In the event of inconsistency between this Annex and any parent framework or Annex O provision regarding access denial by the IRGC, this Annex shall govern.

Cross-Reference: This Annex operates in conjunction with **Annex O (IAEA Access and Site Integrity Protocol)** and **Annex P (Damaged Material Protocol)**. All access rights, damage assessment procedures, personnel protections, data ownership provisions, and dispute resolution mechanisms established in Annex O apply to activities under this Annex unless explicitly modified herein.

Article 1: Recognition of IRGC Control

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

- 1.1** The Parties formally recognize that the IRGC exercises operational control over access to certain declared nuclear facilities, independent of the AEOL. This recognition is factual, not normative. It does not legitimize IRGC control but acknowledges its operational reality for the purpose of designing effective verification mechanisms.
- 1.2** Iran shall provide to the IAEA and JIG a complete list of IRGC-controlled access points within thirty (30) days of entry into force of this Annex. The list shall be updated within seven (7) days of any change.

1.1 IRGC-Controlled Facilities

IRGC-controlled facilities include, but are not limited to, the following declared nuclear sites:

Table Q-1: IRGC-Affected Facilities and Access Impact

FACILITY	IRGC CONTROL POINT	IAEA ACCESS IMPACT	MITIGATION REQUIRED
Natanz Enrichment Plant	Perimeter security; internal checkpoints; above-ground hall entry controls	Inspector movement within facility may be delayed or denied at IRGC checkpoints	NAC pre-clearance; IRGC checkpoint standing orders; inspector credentials recognized
Fordow Enrichment Plant	Tunnel entrance security; underground access zones; shaft entry controls	Access to deep tunnels requires IRGC approval; underground movement restricted	NAC tunnel access authorization; IRGC escort protocols; emergency egress procedures
Esfahan Technology Center	Certain building perimeters; selected storage area controls; cylinder movement checkpoints	Storage areas may be blocked; cylinder inspection may be delayed	NAC building access orders; IRGC coordination with AEOL facility managers
Other Designated Facilities	As specified in the confidential annex or as notified by Iran under Section 1.2	Per facility assessment	Tailored access protocols developed jointly by IAEA, NAC, and facility commanders

Confidential Annex: Iran may designate additional facilities or access points as IRGC-controlled through a confidential annex to this Annex Q, shared only with the IAEA Director General and JIG leadership. The confidential annex shall be reviewed and updated every 90 days.

1.2 Notification Requirements

Within thirty (30) days of entry into force, Iran shall deliver to the IAEA and JIG:

- A complete list of all IRGC-controlled access points at declared nuclear facilities
- The name and rank of the IRGC commander responsible for each access point
- The chain of command from the facility-level IRGC commander to the NAC
- Any standing orders or protocols currently governing IAEA inspector access at each point
- A map or diagram showing the location of IRGC checkpoints within each facility

Iran shall update this information within seven (7) days of any change, including: changes in IRGC command personnel; new IRGC-controlled access points; changes in standing orders or protocols; and closure or consolidation of previously controlled points.

Failure to provide the initial list within 30 days, or to update within 7 days of a change, constitutes a Tier 1 technical breach under parent framework Article 13.

Article 2: National Government Responsibility for IRGC Compliance

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

2.1 The national government of Iran, including the Presidency, the Supreme National Security Council (SNSC), and the AEOI, shall ensure IRGC compliance with IAEA access rights under Annex O. Iran's obligations under Annex O extend to the IRGC as an arm of the state.

2.2 Failure of the IRGC to comply with IAEA access rights shall be treated as failure of Iran to comply. No distinction between "IRGC denied access" and "Iran denied access" shall be recognized under this Annex or any parent framework.

2.1 Binding Directives

The national government of Iran shall issue binding directives to the IRGC requiring full cooperation with IAEA inspectors and remote sensing deployments. These directives shall, at a minimum:

- Require IRGC personnel at all declared nuclear facilities to permit unfettered IAEA inspector access in accordance with Annex O, Article 1
- Mandate that IRGC checkpoints recognize IAEA inspector credentials as valid authorization for entry
- Prohibit IRGC personnel from denying, delaying, or restricting IAEA access on any grounds other than verified radiation safety or structural stability concerns certified by the NAC
- Require IRGC commanders to comply with access orders issued by the NAC within the timeframes specified in Article 3
- Direct IRGC personnel to cooperate with IAEA remote sensing deployments, including drone overflight, ground vehicle access, and sensor emplacement
- Establish that interference with IAEA activities by IRGC personnel is a violation of Iranian national policy and subject to Iranian military discipline

Iran shall provide written confirmation to the JIG, copied to the IAEA Director General, that such directives have been issued to all relevant IRGC commands, within seven (7) days of entry into force of this Annex. The confirmation shall include the date of issuance, the authority that issued the directives (Presidential order, SNSC decision, or equivalent), and the IRGC commands to which the directives were addressed.

The JIG may request a copy of the directives (in Persian with English translation) to verify their scope and binding nature. Iran shall provide such copies within 48 hours of request.

2.2 No Distinction Between IRGC and Iran

For purposes of all obligations under this Annex, Annex O, and any parent framework:

- The IRGC is an organ of the Iranian state. All actions by IRGC personnel at declared nuclear facilities are attributable to Iran.
- Iran may not assert as a defense to an access denial that the IRGC acted independently of the national government.
- Iran may not assert as a defense that the AEOI lacked authority over the IRGC.
- Iran may not assert as a defense that the government is negotiating with the IRGC or that internal consultations are ongoing.
- Any similar argument seeking to distance the national government from IRGC actions shall be rejected as a basis for excusing non-performance.

The sole responsibility of Iran under this Annex is to ensure IAEA access to all declared facilities, including those controlled by the IRGC. How Iran achieves compliance internally — whether through presidential directives, SNSC orders, military chain-of-command, or other mechanisms — is a matter of Iranian domestic law and internal governance, not a basis for delaying or excusing performance under this Annex.

Article 3: National Access Coordinator

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

3.1 Iran shall designate a single National Access Coordinator (NAC) with explicit authority to issue binding access orders to IRGC commanders at all declared nuclear facilities. The NAC shall serve as the single point of contact for all IAEA inspector access matters involving the IRGC.

3.2 The NAC shall respond to any access complaint within two (2) hours during daytime (0600–2200 local time) and six (6) hours overnight (2200–0600 local time). If the NAC fails to resolve an access issue within twelve (12) hours, the dispute is automatically escalated to the JIG.

3.3 Iran may replace the NAC at any time with forty-eight (48) hours' written notice to the IAEA and JIG. Any replacement must meet the qualifications specified in this Article.

3.1 Designation and Authority

The NAC shall be:

- A senior official within the AEOI (Deputy Director level or above) or the Office of the President
- Designated by name and title in writing to the IAEA Director General and JIG Secretariat within seven (7) days of entry into force
- Invested by the Iranian government with explicit, documented authority to issue binding access orders to IRGC commanders at all declared nuclear facilities
- Fluent in English or provided with a certified interpreter available on two (2) hours' notice
- Contactable 24 hours per day, 7 days per week through secure communication channels

The NAC's authority shall include:

- Issuing binding orders to IRGC facility commanders to permit IAEA inspector access
- Overruling IRGC access denials at declared nuclear facilities
- Coordinating with AEOI facility directors and IRGC security officers to resolve access disputes
- Authorizing emergency access for safety inspections or radiation monitoring
- Referring unresolved disputes to the JIG under the escalation protocol in Article 3.2

3.2 NAC Response Protocol

The following protocol governs all NAC interactions with IAEA inspectors and the escalation of access disputes:

Table Q-2: NAC Response and Escalation Protocol

TIME FROM COMPLAINT	ACTION REQUIRED	RESPONSIBLE PARTY
T+0	IAEA inspector or team leader contacts NAC via designated hotline, secure phone, or encrypted communication channel	IAEA inspection team
T+30 minutes	NAC acknowledges receipt of complaint; records nature of access issue, facility location, and IRGC personnel involved	NAC duty officer
T+2 hours (daytime)	NAC issues binding access order to IRGC facility commander; confirms order transmitted in writing	NAC
T+6 hours (overnight)	Same as above for complaints filed between 2200 and 0600 local time	NAC
T+4 hours	IRGC facility commander confirms receipt of NAC order and reports compliance or raises documented safety concern	IRGC facility commander
T+12 hours	If access not resolved, NAC escalates to JIG with full incident report	NAC (mandatory)
T+12 hours	JIG convenes emergency consultation; contacts Iranian government and IRGC central command	JIG Secretariat
T+24 hours	If still unresolved, IAEA certifies access denial; expedited consequences under Article 6 activate	IAEA Director General

NAC Hotline: The NAC shall maintain a dedicated, secure communication line staffed 24/7. Contact details shall be provided to all IAEA inspection teams, the JIG Secretariat, and guarantor states. The IAEA may test the hotline monthly; Iran shall confirm operational status within 24 hours of any test.

3.3 Replacement of NAC

Iran may replace the NAC at any time by providing forty-eight (48) hours' written notice to the IAEA Director General and JIG Secretariat. The notice shall include the name and qualifications of the replacement, who must meet all criteria specified in Article 3.1.

During any transition period between NACs, the outgoing NAC shall remain available for consultation. Iran shall designate an interim NAC within 12 hours of a vacancy to ensure continuous coverage.

PREAMBLE

The IAEA may request the replacement of the NAC if it determines, by written assessment to the JIG, that the NAC has failed to perform the functions of the office on three or more occasions within a 90-day period. The JIG shall review the request within 72 hours and may recommend replacement to Iran. Iran is not bound by the JIG recommendation but shall provide a written response within 48 hours.

Article 4: IRGC Denial Equals Iranian Denial

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

4.1 For purposes of Annex O, Article 6.2 (Consequences of Access Denial), any denial, delay, or restriction imposed by IRGC personnel at a declared nuclear facility constitutes denial by Iran. Iran may not assert any defense seeking to distance the national government from IRGC actions.

This Article establishes the legal framework for treating IRGC access denials as Iranian state denials. The following provisions apply:

Attribution Standard. An access denial is attributable to the IRGC, and therefore to Iran, if any of the following conditions are met:

- IRGC personnel physically blocked, restrained, or turned away IAEA inspectors
- IRGC personnel refused to recognize IAEA inspector credentials or authorization
- An IRGC commander issued an order denying or delaying IAEA access
- IRGC-controlled checkpoints refused entry to IAEA inspectors or equipment
- IRGC personnel interfered with IAEA remote sensing operations (drone jamming, sensor disablement, signal spoofing)
- IRGC personnel threatened or intimidated IAEA inspectors

Prohibited Defenses. Iran may not assert, and the JIG and any arbitral panel shall reject, the following defenses to an IRGC-led access denial:

- "The IRGC acted independently of the national government"
- "The AEOI lacked authority over the IRGC at that facility"
- "The government is negotiating with the IRGC to resolve the issue"
- "The IRGC has its own chain of command"
- "The access denial was an isolated act by a local commander"
- "The government was not informed of the denial in time to respond"
- Any other argument seeking to characterize the IRGC as an independent actor not subject to Iranian government authority

Irrelevance of Internal Process. How Iran organizes its internal governance, including the relationship between the Presidency, SNSC, AEOI, and IRGC, is a matter of Iranian domestic law. The structure of Iran's government does not affect Iran's international obligations under this Annex. The sole question in any compliance assessment is whether IAEA inspectors were granted the access to which they are entitled under Annex O. If access was denied by IRGC personnel, Iran has failed to meet its obligation, regardless of internal chain-of-command structures.

Tier Classification for IRGC-Led Denials: An IRGC-led access denial that persists beyond 24 hours constitutes a Tier 2 material breach under parent framework Article 13. An IRGC-led denial that persists beyond 72 hours automatically escalates to Tier 3. See Article 6 for the complete expedited consequences timeline.

Article 5: Guarantor State Verification via National Technical Means

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

5.1 Guarantor states may independently verify whether an access denial was IRGC-led using their national technical means (NTM). NTM data may be shared with the IAEA, JIG, or other guarantor states at the discretion of the collecting state.

5.2 A finding by three or more guarantor states that an access denial was IRGC-led shall create a presumption to that effect in any JIG or PCA proceeding, rebuttable only by clear and convincing evidence from Iran.

Cross-Reference: The right of guarantor states to collect and use NTM data is established under **Annex O, Article 5.3 (National Technical Means Saving Clause)**. All provisions of that clause apply to NTM activities under this Annex.

Permitted NTM Applications for IRGC Verification:

Table Q-3: NTM Applications for IRGC Access Denial Verification

NTM SOURCE		WHAT IT CAN VERIFY	LIMITATIONS AND CONSIDERATIONS
Satellite (EO/SAR)	Imagery	Presence of IRGC vehicles or personnel at facility access points; movement patterns; blockades at checkpoints	Weather dependent for EO; limited ability to identify individual personnel; may not capture real-time denial event
Signals (SIGINT)	Intelligence	IRGC communications preceding or following access denial; command-level orders to facility personnel	Subject to classification by collecting state; chain of custody for signals intercepts; encryption may limit access
Human (HUMINT)	Intelligence	Direct observation of IRGC personnel denying access; verbal orders; on-site reporting from sources	Source protection considerations; reliability assessment required; may not be shareable without compromising sources
Open-Source Intelligence (OSINT)		Social media posts by IRGC personnel; public statements; facility worker reports	Verification of authenticity required; may be planted or manipulated; corroboration needed

Sharing and Discretion. NTM data collected by a guarantor state is the property of that state. Sharing with the IAEA, JIG, or other guarantor states is at the sole discretion of the collecting state. No Party may demand disclosure of NTM data from a guarantor state. If NTM data is shared, the collecting state may impose classification and handling requirements, including restrictions on further dissemination.

Presumption of IRGC-Led Denial. If three or more guarantor states independently determine, based on their NTM, that an access denial was IRGC-led, this creates a rebuttable presumption in any JIG or PCA proceeding. Iran may rebut this presumption only by presenting clear and convincing evidence that:

- The denial was not made by IRGC personnel, or
- The denial was justified by a verified radiation safety or structural stability concern certified by the NAC, or
- The denial was made in error by non-IRGC personnel and was corrected within 12 hours of discovery

The burden of rebuttal rests entirely on Iran. The standard of proof is "clear and convincing evidence," which is higher than the preponderance standard but lower than beyond reasonable doubt.

Article 6: Expedited Consequences for IRGC-Led Denials

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

- 6.1** IRGC-led access denials trigger accelerated breach consequences. The 7-day pre-arbitration consultation period established in Annex O, Article 6.1-A does not apply to denials determined to be IRGC-led. Instead, the following expedited timeline shall apply.
- 6.2** Each 24-hour period of IRGC-led denial, commencing 24 hours after the initial access request, constitutes one Tier 2 material breach. After 72 hours, the breach automatically escalates to Tier 3.

Expedited Consequences Timeline for IRGC-Led Denials:

Table Q-4: Expedited Consequences Timeline for IRGC-Led Access Denials

TIME PERIOD	ACTION	CONSEQUENCE
0–2 hours	IAEA inspector contacts NAC; NAC acknowledges and begins resolution	NAC has 2 hours to resolve the issue through binding order to IRGC commander
2–12 hours	If unresolved, IAEA notifies JIG; JIG contacts NAC and IRGC central command	JIG emergency consultation activated; NAC and Iranian government put on formal notice
12–24 hours	If still unresolved, IAEA certifies access denial to JIG with full documentation	7-day pre-arbitration consultation period under Annex O, Article 6.1-A is waived for IRGC-led denials
24+ hours	Each 24-hour period of continued IRGC-led denial	Each period constitutes one (1) Tier 2 material breach under parent framework Article 13
72+ hours	Automatic escalation after 72 hours of continuous denial	Escalates to Tier 3 automatically; no separate JIG vote required for escalation

Tier 3 Downgrade Exception. The JIG may vote to downgrade a Tier 3 IRGC-led denial back to Tier 2 by a two-thirds majority vote, but only if Iran demonstrates credible, documented good-faith resolution efforts, including: the NAC issued binding orders to the IRGC; senior Iranian officials (Presidency or SNSC level) intervened directly with IRGC leadership; and concrete steps were taken to resolve the denial within 72 hours. The downgrade does not erase the Tier 2 breaches accrued during the denial period.

Expedited Arbitration. PCA arbitration for IRGC-led denials shall begin within forty-eight (48) hours of the first Tier 2 breach certification, unless Iran demonstrates that the denial has been fully resolved (IAEA inspectors granted access and verification completed) before the 48-hour deadline.

Guarantor State Proportional Consequences. Guarantor states may impose proportional consequences under parent framework Article 12 without awaiting JIG or PCA determination, provided they report such actions to the JIG within 24 hours. Permitted proportional consequences include: suspension of economic benefits; travel restrictions on designated IRGC officials; financial sanctions on IRGC-linked entities; and other measures consistent with the guarantor state's domestic law.

Automatic Escalation Note: The automatic Tier 3 escalation at 72 hours is a structural feature of this Annex, not a punitive measure. It reflects the principle that IRGC control of nuclear facility access is a known risk that Iran has accepted responsibility for managing. A 72-hour failure to resolve an IRGC-led denial indicates a systemic compliance failure by Iran, not an isolated incident.

Article 7: Dispute Resolution

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

7.1 Disputes under this Annex shall be resolved through the dispute resolution mechanisms established in Annex O, Article 6, with the modifications specified herein.

7.2 For IRGC-led access denials, the pre-arbitration consultation period is waived and the expedited timeline in Article 6 applies. For all other disputes under this Annex, the standard 7-day consultation period applies.

Disputes Subject to This Article include, but are not limited to:

- Whether an access denial was IRGC-led or attributable to another cause
- Whether the NAC has the requisite authority or is performing adequately
- Whether Iran has issued the required binding directives to the IRGC
- Disputes over the interpretation or weight of NTM evidence
- Whether the IRGC-controlled facilities list under Article 1 is complete and accurate
- Whether the expedited consequences timeline was properly applied
- Any other matter preventing IAEA access due to IRGC actions or inactions

Expedited Timeline for IRGC-Led Denial Disputes:

- **PCA ruling:** Within five (5) days of filing (not seven days)
- **Provisional measures:** Panel may order mandatory access within forty-eight (48) hours of filing, including specific orders directed to IRGC commanders
- **No 7-day consultation period:** The standard pre-arbitration consultation is waived per Article 6
- **NTM evidence admissible:** NTM-derived evidence submitted by guarantor states is admissible in proceedings under this Article, subject to the collecting state's consent to disclosure

Standard Timeline for Non-IRGC Disputes:

- For disputes under this Annex that do not involve IRGC-led denials (e.g., NAC authority disputes, facility list completeness), the standard 7-day pre-arbitration consultation period under Annex O, Article 6.1-A applies
- PCA ruling within seven (7) days of filing
- All other Annex O, Article 6 provisions apply without modification

Cross-Reference: All provisions of **Annex O, Article 6** regarding PCA panel composition (three members), seat (The Hague), language (English), provisional measures, binding effect, and burden of justification apply to disputes under this Annex, except as explicitly modified above.

Article 8: Relationship to Annex O and Parent Framework

8.1 Annex O access rights, damage assessment protocols, remote sensing procedures, data ownership provisions, personnel protections, and arbitration mechanisms remain in full force and apply to all activities under this Annex unless explicitly modified herein.

8.2 Where this Annex and Annex O conflict on the treatment of access denials involving the IRGC, this Annex governs. Specifically, this Annex supersedes Annex O on: the expedited consequences timeline (Article 6); the attribution of IRGC actions to Iran (Article 4); the role of the NAC (Article 3); and the use of NTM evidence (Article 5).

8.3 All other provisions of Annex O and the parent framework remain unaffected by this Annex.

Table Q-5: Hierarchy of Governing Provisions for IRGC-Related Issues

ISSUE	PRIMARY GOVERNING PROVISION	SECONDARY REFERENCE	TERTIARY REFERENCE
IRGC attribution to Iran	This Annex, Article 4	Annex O, Article 6.2 (consequences)	Parent framework Article 13 (tiers)
Expedited consequences	This Annex, Article 6	Annex O, Article 6.1-A (consultation)	Parent framework Article 13 (tiers)
NAC authority and role	This Annex, Article 3	Annex O, Article 1.4 (personnel protections)	This Annex, Article 2.1 (directives)
NTM evidence	This Annex, Article 5	Annex O, Article 5.3 (NTM saving)	This Annex, Article 7 (disputes)
Dispute resolution	This Annex, Article 7	Annex O, Article 6 (PCA arbitration)	Parent framework Article 13 (tiers)
Physical access to facilities	Annex O, Article 1	Annex O, Article 5 (remote sensing)	This Annex, Article 1.2 (notification)

Article 9: Incorporation by Reference

9.1 This Annex may be incorporated into any existing or future agreement between the Parties by the following adoption sentence:

"The Parties adopt Annex Q (IRGC Access Compliance Protocol) as an operative provision of this Agreement. In the event of any inconsistency, Annex Q shall govern with respect to access denials arising from IRGC control of nuclear facilities."

9.2 No further amendment of the parent framework is required. This Annex enters into force upon the later of: (a) signature by both Parties; or (b) the effective date of the parent framework into which it is incorporated.

Article 9-A: Relationship to Annex O Entry into Force

If Annex O (IAEA Access and Site Integrity Protocol) has already entered into force, this Annex Q shall enter into force upon signature by both Parties. If Annex O has not yet entered into force, this Annex Q shall enter into force simultaneously with Annex O.

This provision ensures that Annex Q is never operative without the underlying access and verification infrastructure that Annex O provides. Annex Q depends on Annex O for the definition of access rights, damage assessment, remote sensing, and arbitration; it cannot function as a standalone instrument.

Article 10: Provisional Application

10.1 The Parties may agree to apply this Annex provisionally for a period of ninety (90) days, pending formal ratification or incorporation into a parent framework.

10.2 Provisional application shall be effected by an exchange of diplomatic notes between the Parties, copied to the Joint Secretariat and all guarantor states.

10.3 During provisional application, all provisions of this Annex shall be operative and binding. Iran shall designate the NAC and issue IRGC directives within the timelines specified in Articles 2 and 3.

10.4 Either Party may terminate provisional application with fourteen (14) days' written notice to the other Party, the Joint Secretariat, and the IAEA Director General.

10.5 Termination of provisional application by Iran triggers immediate JIG review and simultaneous notification to all guarantor states under the procedures specified in Annex O, Article 8.5. All consequences specified in Annex O, Article 8.5 shall apply to termination of this Annex.

10.6 Termination of provisional application does not relieve either Party of obligations under the IAEA Statute or existing Safeguards Agreement. All IAEA safeguards rights and Iran's safeguards obligations continue in full force regardless of the status of this Annex.

Article 11: Duration and Withdrawal

11.1 This Annex shall remain in force indefinitely, unless: (a) both Parties agree in writing to terminate it; or (b) the parent framework into which it is incorporated terminates, and the Parties do not reaffirm this Annex within ninety (90) days of such termination.

11.2 Withdrawal from this Annex without withdrawal from the parent framework is not permitted. This Annex is integral to the access compliance architecture for nuclear facilities under IRGC control and may not be severed unilaterally.

11.3 If the parent framework terminates and this Annex is not reaffirmed within ninety (90) days, all obligations under this Annex expire, but IAEA monitoring data collected during this Annex's operation remains the property of the IAEA and may be used for safeguards purposes under the IAEA Statute and applicable safeguards agreements.

11.4 Implementation Flexibility. The Parties recognize that IRGC organizational structures may change over time. Timelines and technical requirements in this Annex may be adjusted by mutual written agreement of the IAEA Director General and the Head of the Iranian Atomic Energy Organization (AEOI), with notification to the JIG. Unilateral extension or modification is not permitted. Any mutually agreed adjustment shall specify: the revised timeline or requirement; the technical justification; the conditions for return to the original timeline; and the notification provided to the JIG.

11.4-A. Guarantor Oversight of Mutual Adjustments. Any mutual agreement under Article 11.4 shall also be submitted to all guarantor states simultaneously with notification to the JIG. If three or more guarantor states object in writing within seven (7) calendar days of receipt, the adjustment shall be suspended pending JIG review. The JIG may reinstate the adjustment only by a two-thirds majority vote of all JIG members. The burden of demonstrating that the adjustment is technical, not political, and that it does not materially delay the parent framework's objectives rests on the Parties requesting the adjustment. This provision does not apply to day-to-day operational coordination, which requires only JIG notification.

This provision is not a general escape clause; it is a limited flexibility mechanism for genuinely unforeseen changes in IRGC organizational structure. The burden of demonstrating that circumstances are unforeseen and material rests on the Party requesting the adjustment.

Signature Block

In witness whereof, the undersigned, being duly authorized by their respective governments, have signed this Annex Q: IRGC Access Compliance Protocol.

Done at _____, this _____ day of _____, 2026, in triplicate in the English language.

For the Islamic Republic of Iran:

Name:
Title:
Date:

For the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA):

Name: Rafael Mariano Grossi, Director General
Date:

For the United States of America (as endorsing Party, if parent framework applies):

Name:
Title:
Date:

Witnessed by the Guarantor States:

Oman

Pakistan

Qatar

European Union (E3+)

People's Republic of China

Russian Federation